

Billingham Cutting-Edge Lecturers, IAA Symposium on SETI (session A4.2)

The Billingham Cutting-Edge Lecture opens the SETI II session (A4.2, SETI and Society) of the IAA Symposium on the Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence at the International Astronautical Congress. The SETI Committee established it at its 2005 meeting in Fukuoka to showcase breakthrough thinking in SETI, in honour of Dr John Billingham, long-time member and former Chair of the Committee.

Year	Congress	Lecturer	Lecture
2026	Antalya	Kathryn Denning	A New Version of the SETI Protocols: The "Declaration of Principles Concerning the Conduct of the Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence (SETI): 2026 Update
2025	Sydney	Carol Oliver	The case of the EQ Peg hoax 25 years ago: Would a replay in today's media landscape have the same result?
2024	Milan	Daniela De Paulis	Global Outreach and Cultural Impact of A Sign in Space, an Interdisciplinary Simulation of a First Contact Scenario
2023	Baku	Lori Walton	The History of the IAA SETI Permanent Committee – 1990 to 1999
2022	Paris	Daniela De Paulis	A Sign in Space: an Interdisciplinary Exploration of the Potential Reception of an Extraterrestrial Signal
2021	Dubai	<i>Not identified</i>	
2020	Online (CyberSpace Edition)	<i>Not identified</i>	
2019	Washington DC	Andrea Harrington	SETI and International Space Law
2018	Bremen	Leslie I. Tennen	Review of the SETI Post-Detection and Reply Protocols: Current Actions and Developments
2017	Adelaide	Morris Jones	Dealing with Fringe SETI and Media Sensationalism
2016	Guadalajara	<i>Not identified</i>	<i>No programme available.</i>
2015	Jerusalem	Lori Walton	The History of the SETI Permanent Committee (with Stéphane Dumas)
2014	Toronto	Jon Lomberg	SETI's New Horizons
2013	Beijing	H. Paul Shuch	Analyzing the Stephens Mystery Signal
2012	Naples	No lecture given	
2011	Cape Town	Gen. Simon P. (Pete) Worden	Expanding Human and Other Earth Life into the Universe
2010	Prague	Paul Davies	Footprints of Alien Technology
2009	Daejeon	James N. Gardner	How Cosmological Models Should Guide SETI Search Strategies
2008	Glasgow	Iván Almár	Do We Interpret SETI Terms Correctly?
2007	Hyderabad	Kathryn Denning	Being Technological
2006	Valencia	Steven J. Dick	The Postbiological Universe

Shaded rows in italics: no lecturer is confirmed in the available sources. Where the IAF programme does not label the lecture, the opening paper of the session is given for reference only; it should not be assumed to have been the lecture.

Sources

IAA SETI Permanent Committee, "Billingham Cutting-Edge Lecture" (setileague.org/iaaseti/jb_lect.htm, last updated 14 September 2015): 2006–2015.

IAA SETI Permanent Committee, programme of the 43rd Symposium on SETI, IAC 2014 Toronto (setileague.org/iaaseti/prog14.htm): confirms 2014.

IAF Congress browser programmes for IAC-17 to IAC-25, sessions A4.1 and A4.2 (iafastro.directory), saved March 2026. The lectures are labelled KEYNOTE in 2022, 2023 and 2024 only.

Compiled by Michael Garrett, 28 September 2026